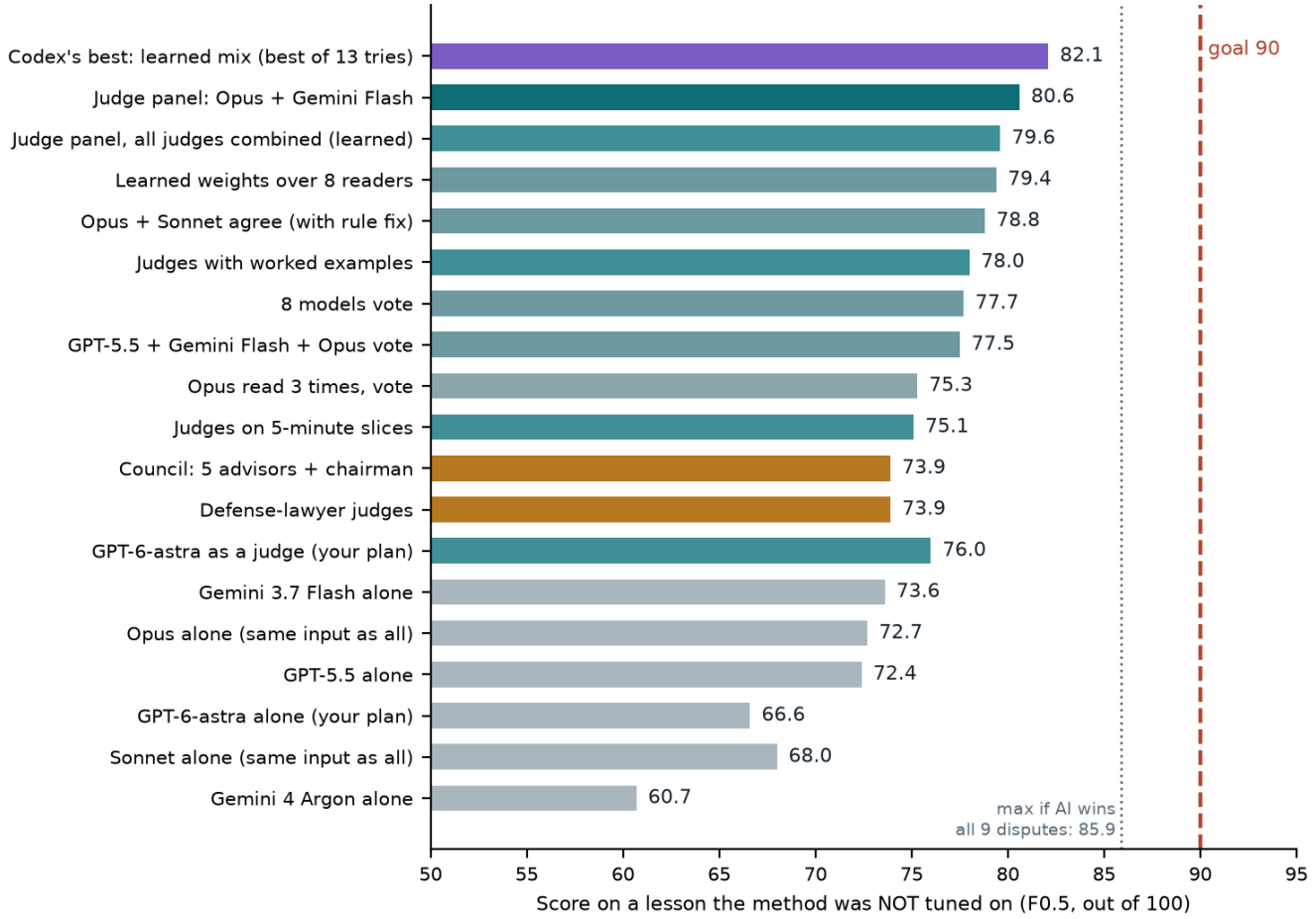
Overnight test: can the AI reach 90?

No. The best honest score is 80.6 (Codex reached 82.1 after 13 tries, inside the noise). Your answer key itself is about 90% reliable, so 90 is roughly the ceiling.



Score = F0.5: how many of your 102 marked mistakes it caught, plus how many of its flags were real (fake flags count double). Every score here is on a lesson the method did NOT learn from (tune on 2 lessons, test on the 3rd, rotate).

Your one action: check the 9 disputed moments on page 3 (about 10 minutes).

The 3 things that mattered

Finding	Effect
Stop counting "you asked for a word" and "no reaction" moments as mistakes (your grade book already does)	+5 to +10 points on every method
A judge panel (Opus + Gemini Flash) ruling on every model's flags	best overall: 80.6
Reading the same lesson 3 times and voting	+2.6 for Opus (72.7 to 75.3)

What did NOT help

- Council (5 advisors + chairman): 73.9. On the 33 borderline flags the chairman was right only 16 times.
- Defense-lawyer judges: 73.9. They clear too many real mistakes.
- More judges (adding Sonnet and Gemini Pro): 76.1. Weaker judges dilute the strong ones.
- Short 5-minute slices: 75.1. The judge loses the lesson context.
- Gemini 4 Argon (Google's top model): 60.7. It flags too much.
- Making the test fair (everyone gets the same pasted input) barely changed the ranking: Opus 72.5 to 72.7.

Every method in plain words

Method	What it does	Score	Caught /102	Flags real
Codex's best: learned mix (best of 13 tries)	judges + reader support + repeat runs, weights learned per type	82.1	68	87%
Judge panel: Opus + Gemini Flash	every model's flags pooled, two judges rule on each	80.6	68	85%
Judge panel, all judges combined (learned)	judges + reader votes + tutor signal, weights learned	79.6	64	85%
Learned weights over 8 readers	learns which models and clues to trust	79.4	67	84%
Opus + Sonnet agree (with rule fix)	the live reader, plus dropping "asked" moments	78.8	69	82%
Judges with worked examples	judges also see right/wrong examples from other lessons	78.0	64	83%
8 models vote	keep a flag when enough of 8 models agree	77.7	60	84%
GPT-5.5 + Gemini Flash + Opus vote	your 3-model team	77.5	66	82%
Opus read 3 times, vote	same model 3 times, keep repeated finds	75.3	66	79%
Judges on 5-minute slices	judge sees only the nearby part of the lesson	75.1	67	78%
Council: 5 advisors + chairman	grammar teacher, native speaker, tutor rules, noise skeptic, learner expert	73.9	73	74%
Defense-lawyer judges	judges told to clear him unless clearly corrected	73.9	63	78%
GPT-6-astra as a judge (your plan)	Astra rules on every flag alone	76.0	66	80%
Gemini 3.7 Flash alone	best single model	73.6	58	80%
Opus alone (same input as all)	fair re-run	72.7	73	73%
GPT-5.5 alone		72.4	75	72%
GPT-6-astra alone (your plan)	OpenAI's top model as a reader	66.6	61	68%
Sonnet alone (same input as all)	fair re-run	68.0	65	69%
Gemini 4 Argon alone	Google's top model: flags too much	60.7	74	58%

Why not 90

Limit	Number
Your own key: Amal fully agreed with 78 of your 86 notes on 10-09	about 91% reliable
Mistakes in your key that NO model ever flags	6 of 102
Moments where your key and the AI strongly disagree	9 (below)
Best score if the AI is right on all 9	85.9
Smallest difference 102 mistakes can tell apart from luck	about 4 points

Your check list: 9 moments where your key and the AI disagree

"AI says mistake" = 5 to 8 models flagged it and both judges agreed, but your key does not mark it. "Key says mistake" = your key marks it but both judges said it was not one. Open the lesson at the time and decide.

Who says mistake	Lesson	Time	He said	Amal wanted
Key (AI says no)	10-08	16:14	عصافير	سما
Key (AI says no)	10-08	17:51	When do you watch the sky? (heard بتطلع as look at)	(when does the sun go up) الشمس بتطلع امتى
AI (key says no)	10-08	36:03	ثلاث سنين الماضي	قبل ثلاث سنين
AI (key says no)	10-09	18:36	جبالي	الجبال المفضلين عندي
AI (key says no)	10-09	1:05:02	أكتر بتبسط	بتبسط أكتر
AI (key says no)	10-10	08:43	هذا يوم الخميس	الخميس الجاي
AI (key says no)	10-10	12:16	كان، كان نفس المرة	كانت نفس المرة
AI (key says no)	10-10	14:03	التقيت خطيبتي	التقيت مع خطيبتي
Key (AI says no)	10-10	35:31	طريق التاني	الطريق التاني

Final decisions (Oct 18)

Question	Decision	Status
Listening method	Keep A (ElevenLabs + Gemini re-listens 3x)	Final, live
Rule fix: asked / no-reaction moments	Never a mistake (PR-27)	Shipped, live
Mistake reader	Keep Opus + Sonnet (both agree) - free on your plan	Live; no switch
Challenger	Judge panel Opus + Gemini Flash (80.6) / Codex mix (82.1)	Re-test on next graded lesson
Dropped	Council, debate, defence judges, slices, Fable, Haiku, Gemini 4 Argon, GPT-6-astra, small models	Not worth it
Paid API	Plans first (claude -p, Codex); paid keys only with your yes	Rule in every CLAUDE.md

Why not switch to the challenger now: it is only 1.8-3.3 points ahead (noise is about 4), and it needs 8 readers including paid Gemini/OpenAI calls, while Opus + Sonnet runs free on your plan.

Recommendation

Do	Why
1. Ship the rule fix now: never mark "asked for a word" or "no reaction" moments	Biggest, cheapest gain (+5 to +10), matches your grade book
2. Keep Opus + Sonnet live for now	The judge panel is +1.8 better, inside the 4-point noise
3. Check the 9 moments on page 3	If the AI is right on most, the real score is about 84-86
4. Fully grade 2 more lessons	A locked test set; 3 lessons cannot separate methods under 4 points
5. Then switch to the judge panel if it wins again	Protocol rule: a winner must win again on a new lesson

Honest caveats

• 16 methods were tried on the same 3 lessons. The best of many tries is a little lucky, so expect the real 80.6 to be about 78-80.
• The "asked" rule fix was found by looking at all 3 lessons' errors. It matches your grade book's written rule, but it was not blind.
• OpenAI's credit ran out at the start of the night, so GPT-6-astra, GPT-5.4 and the OpenAI judge did not run.
• Codex was logged out by my earlier mistake; you signed it back in on Oct 18.
• Claude runs used your monthly plan (no extra money). Gemini cost was small; see Google AI Studio billing for the exact amount.
• Nothing live was changed. All files are on the branch claude/reader-90-overnight.

Your one action: check the 9 disputed moments on page 3, then say "ship the rule fix".